

ENDIVE *Cichorium endivia*

Endive is closely related to chicory and forms sprawling rosettes of bitter-tasting, lettuce-like leaves. There are two main types of endive—those with flat, broad leaves that are known as “escarole” or “Batavian,” and those with frilly, finely serrated leaves known as “Frisée” or chicory endive. The feathery leaves are blanched to reduce the bitterness of their taste, and can be used in salads like lettuce.

	SPRING	SUMMER	FALL	WINTER
SOW/PLANT				
HARVEST				

SOWING

Endives like a fertile, well-drained soil and a pH of around 5.5–7.5. They are generally quite tolerant plants and are not too fussy about location—they will grow happily in full sun and will tolerate partial shade, too.

Exposure to cold weather may encourage plants to bolt, so don't plant them out too early. Instead, sow under cover in spring and then plant seedlings out once the soil has warmed up in early or midsummer. Alternatively, sow seed directly into the ground in early summer. Sow seed at a depth of .5 in (1 cm), and later thin seedlings out, depending on type: allow compact varieties about 9 in (23 cm) between plants, and give spreading varieties about



Clay pots can be used to blanch leaves.

15 in (38 cm). Space rows of plants 10–15 in (25–38 cm) apart.

CROP CARE

Keep plants weeded and well-watered at all stages of their growth. Protect crops with cloches or cold frames if the weather turns cold—this will discourage them from bolting and will also extend the length of the harvesting season.